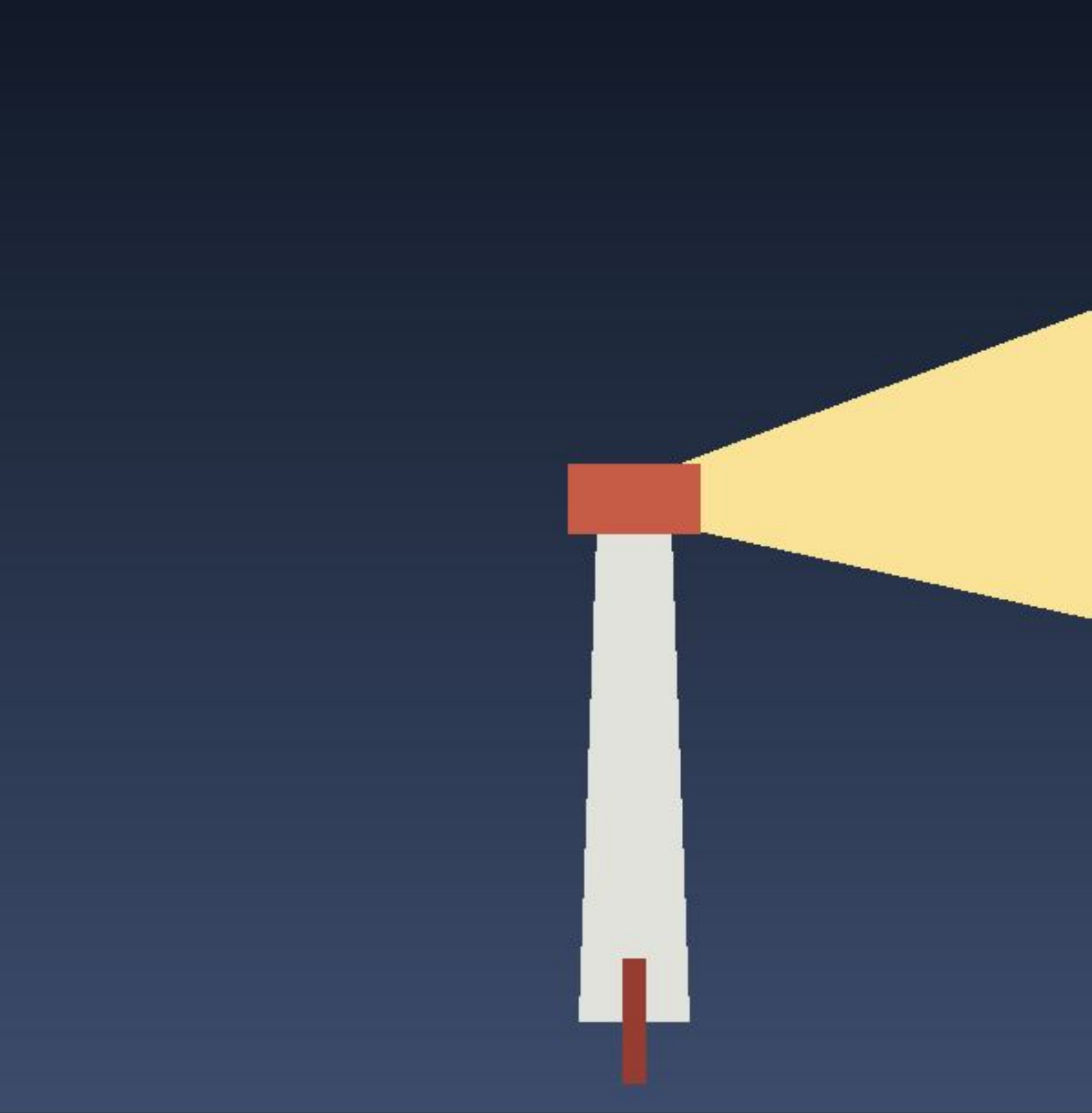




The Lighthouse at Sker
Point

A Wren (QA Corpus)

The Lighthouse at Sker Point

by A. Wren (QA Corpus)

1. The Keeper's Ledger

Maren wrote the log in a hand so small it looked like a line of ants. The wind had been steady for nine days, and the entries repeated themselves: clear at four, clear at eight, nothing on the horizon.

She had inherited the ledger with the post. Nobody had explained the job, only the objects - a brass key, a tin of wick, a book with a leather spine and no title. The keeper's rule was simple and unwritten: the light does not go out.

On the eleventh day the wind changed direction, and with it came a sound she had never heard before, low and patient, like something large moving slowly under the water of the sound.

2. Fog on the Sound

Fog arrived without ceremony. It simply was there at noon, a soft grey wall that swallowed the harbour and then the last hundred metres of rock below the tower.

In fog the work became ritual. Wick trimmed, lens polished, clock wound, log signed. Maren found she liked the ritual. It gave the hours an order the fog had taken away.

She talked to the sea a little. It was not madness, exactly; it was the ordinary courtesy of living alone with something that listens. The sea never answered, but it never left either.

3. What the Lamp Recorded